

Parks and Street Temperature

Abstract

Parks lower the air temperature of the streets around them, but by how much depends on their size, their trees, and the wind. We measured air temperature in twelve parks of one city twice a day for a year and compared it with readings taken at the same hours in the streets nearby. Large parks with tall trees cooled the most, and their effect reached several blocks. Parks lower the air temperature of the streets around them, but by how much depends on their size, their trees, and the wind. We measured air temperature in twelve parks of one city twice a day for a year and compared it with readings taken at the same hours in the streets nearby. Large parks with tall trees cooled the most, and their effect reached several blocks.

Keywords

urban heat island; city parks

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1. Introduction

Cities are warmer than the country around them because pavement and roofs store the heat of the day and release it at night. Parks interrupt this, and planners want to know how large a park must be before the streets around it feel the difference. Cities are warmer than the country around them because pavement and roofs store the heat of the day and release it at night. Parks interrupt this, and planners want to know how large a park must be before the streets around it feel the difference. Cities are warmer than the country around them because pavement and roofs store the heat of the day and release it at night. Parks interrupt this, and planners want to know how large a park must be before the streets around it feel the difference.

Earlier studies measured single parks over a few weeks. We kept the same instruments in twelve parks for a full year so that seasons, winds and park sizes could be compared on one footing. Earlier studies measured single parks over a few weeks. We kept the same instruments in twelve parks for a full year so that seasons, winds and park sizes could be compared on one footing. Earlier studies measured single parks over a few weeks. We kept the same instruments in twelve parks for a full year so that seasons, winds and park sizes could be compared on one footing.